# Nhill brand voice

Français : ../fr/12-voix-de-marque.md

Visual identity (logo, colours, typography): `docs/brand/identite.md` (French).

## 1. Who is speaking

Nhill speaks like **the neighbourhood's trusted shop manager**: knows trade, says things simply, doesn't promise the moon, keeps their word. The name honours Napoleon Hill (aim higher) and evokes the hill you climb: progress step by step.

## 2. Four traits

| Trait | What it is | What it is not |
|---|---|---|
| Clear | short sentences, trade words (till, stock, seller, credit) | jargon ("ERP", "SaaS", "cloud-native", "disruptive") |
| Concrete | an action, a visible benefit ("you see each seller's till") | vague promises ("boost your business") |
| Honest | saying what Nhill doesn't do (standardised invoice, offline) | superlatives, unmeasured figures, fake testimonials |
| Respectful | formal address in French (vous), courtesy, respect for the trader's time | forced familiarity, pressure ("limited offer!") |

## 3. Vocabulary

| Say | Avoid |
|---|---|
| management software, application | solution, disruptive platform |
| sales, stock, till, invoices, customer credit | flows, process, KPIs (with customers) |
| assisted free trial | revolutionary trial |
| management document; does not replace the DGI standardised invoice | DGI-compliant, certified, approved |
| needs the Internet to record; no double entry after a cut | works offline |
| your data belongs to you; export at any time | 100 % secure data, unbreakable |
| business, trader, entrepreneur | end user, target |

## 4. Languages

- **French** by default; **English** for English-speaking partners and customers; a word of Lingala in spoken greetings is welcome, never caricatured.
- French typography: space before `: ; ? !`; amounts "25 000 CDF", "12,50 USD". English: "CDF 25,000", "USD 12.50".

## 5. Examples

| Situation | Recommended wording |
|---|---|
| Poster headline | “Your sales, stock and till, clear.” |
| Answer to “is it secure?” | “Each business is kept separate from the others in the database, communications are encrypted and your password is never stored in plain text. No software is perfect: we fix issues and tell you if there is an incident.” |
| Error in the application | “The server isn’t responding. Check the connection, then press Retry: the sale won’t be recorded twice.” |
| Feature announcement | “New: the F9 key opens payment.” |

## 6. Words never to write

“guaranteed”, “zero errors”, “100 % secure”, “number 1”, “DGI-compliant”, “hundreds of customers” (or any unverified customer count), “recommended by” (without written consent).